

always a need for a 'backup' system. Europe is already facing a gas crunch while China and India face a coal shortage which has led to widespread power outages. The requirement of 'dirty' sources of energy to keep the power sector afloat has not yet been completely substituted. Net zero emissions are a long way away, and till then the world would see huge surge in the demand of electricity that cannot be supplied by renewable sources alone.

PARIS AGREEMENT - IS IT REALISTIC?

The Paris Agreement is a legally binding international treaty adopted by 196 parties at the COP21 in Paris on December 12, 2015. The aim of the agreement is to thaw increasing temperature to a preferred maximum of 1.5 degrees Celsius. Thus challenging the ever-increasing global warming. The goal is to achieve a carbon neutral planet by the mid-century. It also enables collaboration between the participating developed and developing countries to help each other through finance, technology, and capacity building for a cleaner future.

The Paris Agreement is a project that can help our ever-heating planet. Several countries have come forward and implemented several plans to make the dream a reality. Denmark has crossed its solar and wind energy share by 50 per cent, while countries like Uruguay and Luxemburg are nearing that mark.

The power sector needs to hit net-zero emissions by 2040 to achieve the mid-century mark goal. To achieve this feat wind and solar energy need to grow 20 per cent each year to 2030, which does not look to be the case. This means even though renewable energy capacity is growing, it is not growing at a pace that is required. The failure to meet this target means, we will not be stopping a further rise in Earth's temperatures. Electricity generation growth through renewable sources is not growing as per the Paris Agreement's goals.

This might open a plethora of arguments stating 'we are trying.' In reality, we are not trying enough to protect the planet. Scientists say that a global rise in temperature beyond two degrees Celsius will be catastrophic to the



India faced power outages due to coal stocks drying up in 2022

survival of human beings. The damage caused to the living beings and to the planet will be irreversible once the temperature soars. The implementation of the Paris Agreement is essential to have a future.

WHAT THE FUTURE LOOKS LIKE?

Clean electricity on a global scale, in 2022, might look like a distant dream. Global demand for electricity

clear for now that renewable energy alone cannot cut it. A constrained use of coal and pushing the renewable energy infrastructure ahead might help us on our way to a more sustainable future.

Global warming is a result of human activity and only human beings can reduce, or cut down on the greenhouse gas emissions that have pushed us to the edge. Melting of ice caps and increase in the sea levels are irreversible damages or damages that can truly be reversed in hundreds of thousands of years.

Renewable sources of energy, if implemented, can check our carbon emissions, and keep the rising temperature under the fatal levels. However, to achieve this dream, governments must act now!

The future looks bleak from the point of view of climate change right now. Several lives are on the line, facing the wrath of nature every day due to the actions of our previous generations. If the increasing greenhouse gas emissions are not checked now, future generations might see a planet that is almost incapable of sustaining life. That is surely a future we do not want.

Earth is a gift that keeps on giving. The planet already has a substitute source of energy which just has to be developed and implemented. Clean



is set to increase 4 per cent in 2022 owing to economic recoveries in several countries post-pandemic. The year-on-year increase in electricity demand must be sustained, and it is

global electricity might arrive a little late, much later than what was promised in the Paris Agreement, but it for sure is not just a pipe dream. At least if the right efforts are made. **d**